

the United States and the diverse set of organizations and client groups when experiential education has been employed.

The second section presents a series of papers examining the factors that make successful experiential groups. Starting with his own research as a base, Lee Bolman reviews the empirical literature on leader impact and integrates this with his extensive experience as a T-group trainer. He ends his chapter with the provocative idea that his view of the effective group leader contrasts markedly with what Tavistock study group leaders do. David Bradford and Carson Eoyang discuss the use and misuse of structured exercises. Their approach includes a scheme for classifying exercises, distinguishing their purposes, and predicting their advantages and disadvantages according to a variety of criteria. Peter Smith reviews the research on experiential methods to determine what kinds of effectiveness questions have been answered by empirical research. His paper is both hopeful and sobering. It shows that some questions have been answered and others are enormously difficult even to approach.

The second half of the book contains sections on experiential group designs and application of experiential group methods. The writing in this section is of a different order than the first. It is far more concrete. However they conceptualize, the writers are basically reporting about experiential activities they have developed or are evolving. Both the products and the writing have a decidedly less finished quality than the first six chapters. In part this is to be expected once one realizes what is happening. These chapters convey the dilemmas, confusion, and incompleteness of experiential work in the making. Often this part of the field does not appear in writing at all or only after the "rough edges" are removed. Readers who have the patience to continue through sections III and IV will be rewarded by a greater sense of the work itself in experiential group methods. This set of papers also provides rich examples of the nearly limitless creativity available to someone who bothers to learn how to use experiential methods.

As a whole the book is worthy of attention by applied behavioral science professionals; it can also be of value in informing nonbehavioral science faculty in management about the scope and possibilities of education by experiential group methods.

Beyond Culture

By Edward T. Hall

Anchor Press of Doubleday, New York, N.Y., 1977. 320 pp., \$2.95.

Reviewed by Dee G. Appley, University of Massachusetts, Amherst

"Paradoxically, the only way that man can escape the hidden constraints

of covert culture is to involve himself actively and quite consciously in those parts of his life that he takes most for granted" (p. 7). And so Hall urges us to embark on a "massive cultural literacy movement"—a consciousness-raising enterprise in which the pluralistic nature of societies will be acknowledged and respected. Along the way Hall takes us on many paths, not all equally cleared, as we are presented sometimes with anecdotes, sometimes with data, and almost always with the message that things can, indeed must, change. Although Hall tells us that we can never truly understand another person nor indeed ourselves, his is an optimistic message based on a belief in the underdeveloped potential of humankind.

Along the way he introduces us to some of his concerns as anthropologist and as humanist. For example, he contrasts *monochronic time* with *polychronic time* and shows how people with differing time-space frames of reference will have important intercultural misunderstandings. Another important concept he has labelled *extension transference*, which is to say that we have invented ways of enhancing (extending) our functions but then these extensions take on identities of their own and get us into trouble: e.g., religion, language, and others.

Again and again he reminds us of the relationship between an individual and his environment and the importance of *context*. Furthermore, some cultures are *high context* (HC) and some are *low context* (LC) and the difficulties of each are explored both within and between the cultures. He suggests that HC is to LC as Dionysian is to Apollonian thinking. This time using the example of a scientist writing a grant proposal, it is clear that a Dionysian will be unsuccessful in an Apollonian world! And indeed we know by now that Hall is Dionysian (and polychronic and high context) so it would not be fair to look to him to prescribe answers to the problems which he helps to surface if we understand and accept his thesis that these important differences do exist.

He defines some archetypal situations such as birth, death, sex, dominance, etc. and then reminds us how these have been subjugated to time-space requirements in different cultures. Indeed no society has yet found the right balance for human needs-in-a-situation. Furthermore there are *action chains*, requirements of events to be carried out, which can be very persistent, particularly in high context cultures. "Like Freud's unconscious, the cultural unconscious is actively hidden, and like Freud's patients, one is forever driven by the processes that cannot be examined without outside help" (p. 152). He suggests that these unconscious binds probably outnumber conscious ones 1000 to 1! Thus, he advises that we approach each culture anew, as if we know nothing about it.

Still another difference among individuals is in how we fantasize and how we memorize. Hall builds on this point to criticize our educational system which violates much that is known even now about human beings. He tries

to take us under the layers of culture via an understanding of the structure of the brain. Through this discussion he supports his criticism of the educational system because of its misuse of brain potential. And he points out that what we think of as *mind* is really *internalized culture*.

Through tracing human ancestry, we go down another path with Hall to conclude that the ideal group size is eight to twelve, and thus most of our learning situations violate this idea. Along the way he points out the importance of play for young primates, reminding us that for primates learning takes place primarily from peers. Again our educational system suffers by comparison, and bureaucratic structures are clearly antithetical arrangements for human beings. Thus he urges us to study the past and related species in order to arrive at fresh and more compatible learning and working designs.

Acknowledging that people have problems with separation, nevertheless Hall's message is that we must learn to separate ourselves from our culture if we are to go "beyond culture," and fulfill humankind's potentials. Although those readers who are committed to the biological bases of behavior may be put off by the importance of learning in his discussions, and although those who are committed to a social learning point of view may be put off by the biological emphasis, Hall does raise our consciousness about the difficulties of understanding each other in any situation because of our different experiences. Moreover, he makes a strong case for the necessity of re-examining many institutions and organizations which violate our humanness and stand in the way of developing our full potential. He reminds us that we are currently using old maps (the equivalent of Columbus's maps when he set out to explore the external world) to explore human nature, and he urges us to think much more highly of ourselves and our possibilities. True to an Eastern style (which he obviously favors) rather than a Western style, he does not insult us by telling us how this should be done.

Using Social Research in Public Policy Making

By Carol H. Weiss, (Ed.)

Lexington Books, D.C. Heath Co., Lexington, Mass. 1977. 256 pp., \$19.00.

Human Behavior and Public Policy

By Marshall H. Segall

Pergamon Press, New York, 1976. 321 pp., \$9.50 paper; \$18.00 hardback.

Reviewed by Leonard Goodwin, Worcester Polytechnic Institute

These two books mark the increasing concern among social scientists to make their efforts more relevant to human affairs. The books offer very dif-